Official C.M. Four Square Rules

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1. Objective

a. Make it to the 4th square and stay in for as long as possible by correctly returning the ball and avoiding elimination.

2. Setup

a. The court consists of one large square divided into four equal squares, numbered 1 through 4 in clockwise order
    i. Square 1 is the entry level square
    ii. Square 4 is the highest rank and serves each round

b. A kickball is used as the game ball, size may vary

c. One player is assigned to each square
    i. Players may stand outside their square but may not enter another player's square (e.g. The 3rd square player may stand outside the corner line but not into square 2)

3. Gameplay Overview

a. The game consists of a series of rounds

b. Each round starts with a serve and ends when a player is out

c. When a player is out, remaining players rotate clockwise to fill the empty square and a new player enters square 1.

4. Serving

a. The player in square 4 serves to square 2

b. The ball must bounce once in square 4 before being hit

c. The serve must be done in a respectable and fair manner

d. Faulting
    i. Both the server and receiver are allowed one faulty serve per round
    ii. A faulty serve consists of
        1. An invalid hit
        2. Hitting the ball in a manner that would get the player out
        3. Serving before bouncing the ball
        4. Serving in a way that breaks 4c

5. Gameplay Rules

a. If the ball bounces into a players square, they must return it into another square with a valid hit

b. A valid hit is
    i. A single contact
    ii. An underhand hit (see section 6)

c. A player is out if they:
    i. Hit an invalid hit
    ii. Hit the ball out of bounds
        1. The outer line is considered in
        2. The ball bouncing on the inner lines is considered out
    iii. Hit the ball before it bounces in their square
    iv. Allow the ball to bounce twice in their square
    v. Hit the ball after it bounces in another player's square
    vi. Interfere with gameplay in an unsportsmanlike manner

6. Underhand Rule

a. All hits must be hit in underhand style

b. The player's palm must be face up or sideways and at the moment of contact

c. The palm(s) must make contact with the ball

d. Spikes, backhand hits, slams result in an out

7. Continuation Rule

a. If a player commits an action that would make them out, but two or more additional, valid, hits occur before it is called, that player is no longer out